

	Agency Name	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	B – Eligibility Factors
	Section No./Name	B-700 Immunization
	Document No./Name	B-710-FITAP Immunization
	Effective Date	May 1, 2023

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

Sufficient evidence of immunity or immunization against vaccine-preventable diseases recommended by the Office of Public Health schedule must be provided for each recipient under 18 years of age. Sufficient evidence that such an immunization program is up-to-date or in progress may be substituted for proof of immunity or immunization.

Immunizations must be verified at:

- initial application,
- when assistance is requested for an additional child,
- at redetermination, and
- at the midpoint of a 24 month certification period.

The client must be advised of the immunization requirement in writing and allowed 10 days to complete the needed activities and submit verification. If the client fails to cooperate or provide sufficient verification of requested immunization for any child, the client is not eligible for assistance.

EXCEPTIONS: The immunization requirement does not apply if the client:

- submits a written statement from a physician stating that the immunization procedure is inadvisable or contraindicated for medical reasons, or
- *** * verbally states an ** objection to the procedure based on religious grounds.

B-711-FITAP - PO IMMUNIZATION SCHEDULE

The child should obtain immunizations according to the schedule listed in the chart below which is recommended by the Office of Public Health.

The Office of Public Health, [OPH](#) allows exceptions to the Immunization Schedule. Each child's individual circumstances must be considered. A child may not have had all the immunizations listed for his age and may not be required to have all the immunizations listed. A statement from a medical provider (hospital, clinic, health unit, physician, etc.) that a child is up-to-date or in progress with their immunization requirement is sufficient.

Determine the current age of the child. To be in compliance with immunization requirements, immunizations should be administered within 30 days of their birthday based on the child's age shown in the chart below.

	Agency Name	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	B – Eligibility Factors
	Section No./Name	B-700 Immunization
	Document No./Name	B-710-FITAP Immunization
	Effective Date	May 1, 2023

Examples:

If a 6-month old child's birthday is July 2nd, the child will be noncompliant on August 2nd if the recommended immunizations for a 6-month old are not administered.

If a 12-year old child's birthday is June 10th, the child will be noncompliant on July 11th if the recommended immunizations for an 11 – 12 year old are not administered.

Child's Age	Total Recommended Immunizations
Birth	1 HepB
2 Months	1 DTaP, 1 Hib, 1 IPV, 2 HepB, 1 PCV, 1 RV
4 Months	2 DTaP, 2 Hib, 2 IPV, 2 HepB, 2 PCV, 2 RV
6 Months	3 DTaP, 3 Hib, 3 IPV, 3 HepB, 3 PCV, 3 RV
12-15 Months	4 DTaP, 4 Hib, 3 IPV, 3 HepB, 4 PCV, 3 RV, 1 MMR, 1 VAR, 1 HepA
18-23 Months	4 DTaP, 4 Hib, 3 IPV, 3 HepB, 4 PCV, 3 RV, 1 MMR, 1 VAR, 2 HepA
4 Years or Prior to School Entry	5 DTaP, 4 Hib, 4 IPV, 3 HepB, 4 PCV, 3 RV, 2 MMR, 2 VAR, 2 HepA (If DTaP #4 and IPV #3 are given after fourth birthday, only need 4 DTaP and 3 IPV)
11 – 12 Years	5 DTaP, 4 Hib, 4 IPV, 3 HepB, 4 PCV, 3 RV, 2 MMR, 2 VAR, 2 HepA, 1 Tdap, 1 MCV, 1 HPV (VAR, MMR, HepA, HepB if needed)
16 year and above	5 DTaP, 4 Hib, 4 IPV, 3 HepB, 4 PCV, 3 RV, 2 MMR, 2 VAR, 2 HepA, 1 Tdap, 2 MCV, 1 HPV (HPV, VAR, MMR, HepA, HepB if needed)

Subsequent routine Td boosters are recommended every 10 years.

Time sensitive vaccines:

Hib is an abbreviation for Haemophilus Influenza Type B and may be written as Hib Titer, Act Hib, PedVax Hib, or given as combination with HepB (Comvax). No Hib is given after 60 months of age. If Hib vaccines were manufactured by Merck and administered at 2 and 4 months of age, a dose at 6 months is not required.

RV is an abbreviation for Rotavirus Vaccine. The first dose of the RV Vaccine can be administered between 8 weeks of age and 15 weeks of age. The RV cannot be administered later than 8 months (32 weeks) of age. If Monovalent RV1 is administered at 2 months and 4 months of age, a dose at 6 months is not required. Pentavalent RV5 is administered at 2 months, 4 months and 6 – 8 months.

Remaining vaccines recommended:

HepA is an abbreviation for Hepatitis A Vaccine. HepA is recommended for all children 12 months through 18 years of age.

HepB is an abbreviation for Hepatitis B Vaccine. HepB is routinely recommended for all children up to 19 years of age.

DTaP is an abbreviation for Diphtheria, Tetanus and acellular Pertussis. The following vaccines are acceptable as DTaP equivalents: DTP, DTaP, DT, Td, or any combination including these, such as DTP-Hib, DTP-HBV, DTaP-Hib, etc.

 Department of Children & Family Services <i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i>	Agency Name	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	B – Eligibility Factors
	Section No./Name	B-700 Immunization
	Document No./Name	B-710-FITAP Immunization
	Effective Date	May 1, 2023

IPV is an abbreviation for Inactivated Poliovirus Vaccine. The following vaccines are acceptable as equivalents: OPV, eIPV, or any combination including these such as DTP-IPV, etc.

PCV is an abbreviation for Pneumococcal Conjugate Vaccine. All children should receive a 3 dose primary series and a booster if vaccination begun at or before 6 months of age; a 2 dose primary series and a booster if vaccination is begun between 7 and 11 months of age; a 2 dose series and no booster if vaccination is begun between 12 and 23 months of age. If vaccination is initiated at or after 24 months of age, the child should receive 1 dose of PCV. Children 24 through 59 months of age should receive a single dose of PCV13. Children with underlying medical conditions, a single supplemental PCV13 is recommended following primary series. PCV vaccination is required as part of the Daycare/Head Start Immunization Requirement for children less than 24 months of age.

MMR is an abbreviation for Measles, Mumps and Rubella. The following vaccines are acceptable as MMR equivalents: MMR, Measles + Mumps + Rubella, or any combination that includes these, such as MMRV, MMR-Varicella, etc.

VAR is an abbreviation for Varicella. All susceptible children who are at least 12 months old through 18 years of age are eligible.

Tdap is an abbreviation for Tetanus and Diphtheria Toxoids and Acellular Pertussis Vaccine.

HPV is an abbreviation for Human Papillomavirus Vaccine. HPV vaccine is a 2 dose series for ages 9-14 years and a 3 dose series for ages 15-26 years. The first dose is administered between 11-12 years. The second dose is administered 6-12 months after the first dose. If the series was started at 15-26 years, then the third dose is administered at least 12 weeks after the second dose, but no earlier than 24 weeks after the first dose.

MCV is an abbreviation for Meningococcal Conjugate Vaccine. This vaccine should be administered to all children 11-12 years of age, with a booster dose on/after age 16. Only one dose is required if it is given on or after age 16.

Seasonal vaccine:

Flu is an abbreviation for the Influenza Vaccine. Routine annual influenza vaccination is recommended for all children 6 months – 18 years; however, it is not required for a child to be eligible for assistance.

	Agency Name	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	B – Eligibility Factors
	Section No./Name	B-700 Immunization
	Document No./Name	B-710-FITAP Immunization
	Effective Date	May 1, 2023

Example:

A redetermination is completed in August 2015. There are 3 children in the assistance unit.

Sharon is 16 months old. According to the schedule it is recommended that she have 4 DTaP vaccines, 4 Hib vaccines, 3 IPV vaccines, 3 HepB vaccines, 4 PCV vaccines, 3 RV vaccines, 1 MMR vaccine, 1 VAR vaccine, and 1 HepA vaccine to be up to date on immunizations. Her immunization card shows that she has received all vaccines required for her age.

Susan is 9 years old and is enrolled in school. Although Susan is enrolled in school, the client is not sure that she has received all required immunizations. According to the schedule, it is recommended that she have 5 DTaP vaccines, 4 Hib vaccines, 4 IPV vaccines, 3 HepB vaccines, 4 PCV vaccines, 3 RV vaccines, 2 MMR vaccines, 2 VAR vaccines, and 2 HepA vaccines to be up to date on immunizations. Her immunization card shows that she has had 4 DTaP vaccines, 3 IPV vaccines, 2 MMR vaccines, 4 Hib vaccines, 3 HepB vaccines, and 1 VAR vaccine. The client provides a recent statement from the Health Unit that she has completed the immunization process. Although she has not received all the vaccines listed, the statement from the Health Unit is sufficient to verify immunizations are considered to be complete. Susan is considered to be in compliance with the immunization requirement and the statement should be accepted without further verification.

Thomas is 12 years old and client states he is enrolled in school and has received all required immunizations. No further verification is necessary.

For additional information concerning recommended immunizations, refer to <https://www.cdc.gov/vaccines>.

B-712-FITAP - PO VERIFICATION

Verification sources may include hospital, clinic, health unit, school, medical records, private physician's records, Request for Verification of Immunization form ([OFS IM](#)), or [Louisiana Immunization Network for Kids Statewide \(LINKS\)](#).

B-712-1- FITAP - PO [Louisiana Immunization Network for Kids Statewide \(LINKS\)](#) Participants

The Louisiana Department of Health, Office of Public Health, Immunization Program provides an internet website that allows designated users to view immunization records for patients in the LINKS Central Registry. The website is: <https://linksweb.oph.dhh.louisiana.gov>. If a client moves within Louisiana, any participating provider, parish health unit, or designated user in the parish office may retrieve a child's immunization record. All children's immunization records may not appear on the website because a provider may not participate in the LINKS Program or a parent may not want to share their child's information.

 Department of Children & Family Services <i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i>	Agency Name	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	B – Eligibility Factors
	Section No./Name	B-700 Immunization
	Document No./Name	B-710-FITAP Immunization
	Effective Date	May 1, 2023

The LINKS website provides the following information: child's full name, date of birth, gender, mother's maiden name, guardian's first name (when applicable), address, phone number, immunization record and other information which may determine eligibility for free vaccines.

If the LINKS Patient Vaccination Summary printout indicates "up-to-date" or "due now," the child is considered to be in compliance with the immunization requirement. The LINKS printout should be accepted without further verification.

An explanation of the LINKS terms Due Now, Past Due and Up-to-Date are as follows:

- Due Now - As of today's date, the patient's age falls between the recommended minimum age and recommended maximum age for this dose and the absolute minimum interval has been met since last dose.
- Past Due - As of today's date, the recommended maximum age or the recommended maximum for this dose has passed. (30 days after the date due which is the child's birthday).
- Up-to-Date - As of today's date, the patient is not due or past due.

B-712-2-FITAP - PO Non-LINKS Participants

Refer to [B-712-2-PR](#) for the procedure staff must follow regarding Non-LINKS Participants.

II. PROCEDURES

At initial application, when assistance is requested for an additional child, redetermination, and at the midpoint of a 24-month certification period:

- advise the client of the immunization requirement,
- discuss and determine with the client each child's immunization status to determine what action is necessary on the part of the client to meet the requirement:
 - For school aged children, accept the client's statement made verbally that the child has had all required immunizations if the client states that the child is currently enrolled in school. Document this information in Case Notes.
 - For all other children, review LINKS. For example, does the client need to make an appointment to have the child immunized or does the client only need to submit verification of the child's immunization record?
- advise the client in writing of any actions needed to meet the requirement, and
- give the client 10 days to complete the needed activities and submit verification.

	Agency Name	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	B – Eligibility Factors
	Section No./Name	B-700 Immunization
	Document No./Name	B-710-FITAP Immunization
	Effective Date	May 1, 2023

If immunization records received indicate that the child's immunizations are up-to-date or in progress, document the *** * immunization status on the LITE Immunization – Details screen. ** If a child's health care provider provides a written statement or documentation of recent immunizations indicating that the child is considered to be either: complete, up-to-date, contraindicated, or in progress, document the *** * status on the LITE Immunization Details screen.

If verification is not received or if verification shows the child is not up-to-date or in progress:

- contact the client to determine the reason, and
- offer the client assistance in making arrangements for:
 - obtaining needed immunization(s), and/or
 - obtaining needed verification.

If the client fails to cooperate or provide requested immunization or sufficient verification for any child included in the assistance unit, clearly document the offer of assistance in the case record, and:

- at application, the application must be rejected.
- for certified cases, the case must be closed and remain closed for at least one month and until all children are in compliance:
 - Work-eligible families: apply the appropriate STEP sanction occurrence and reason.
 - Non work-eligible families: close the case using the appropriate coding. ** The case must remain closed for at least one month and until the child meets the immunization requirements.

B-711-FITAP - PR IMMUNIZATION SCHEDULE

Compare the immunization verification obtained to the immunization schedule as outlined in the chart in Section I based on the child's age.

B-712-FITAP - PR VERIFICATION

Staff must verify immunizations are up-to-date or in progress:

- at the initial application,
- when assistance is requested for an additional child,
- at redetermination, and

	Agency Name	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	B – Eligibility Factors
	Section No./Name	B-700 Immunization
	Document No./Name	B-710-FITAP Immunization
	Effective Date	May 1, 2023

- at the midpoint of a 24 month certification period.

B-712-1-FITAP - PR [Louisiana Immunization Network for Kids Statewide \(LINKS\)](#) Participants

Each parish office has two individuals who have access to the [LINKS](#) website. One person serves as the primary user and another serves as back-up. If the primary user leaves or changes employment with DCFS, the *** ES Manager** must notify LDH. This user's identification number must be deactivated. LDH will provide the name of the person to contact in such an event. If the back-up user departs, the primary user has all the responsibility for verifying immunization until another back-up is named. LDH must be notified of all changes timely.

B-712-2-FITAP - PR Non-LINKS Participants

If a **non-school aged **** child's health care provider is not a participant of the LINKS program or a parent or caretaker refuses to share their child's information through LINKS, staff must:

- request sufficient verification, or
- provide form [OFS IM](#) to the client for completion.

B-713-FITAP - PR DOCUMENTATION

Document verification of immunization or any exceptions to this requirement on ***** * the LITE Immunization – Details screen.**

If a copy of the immunization record, or form [OFS IM](#) is used to verify the child's immunization status it must be scanned into OnBase and the LITE Immunization – Details screen must be updated to reflect *Medical/Clinical/Health Unit/Physician's Records* as the Verification Source. **

***** * If the child's immunization records are complete and up-to-date on LINKS, the current LINKS Patient Vaccination Summary printout must include the worker's signature or digital signature, the date the printout was reviewed and scanned into OnBase. The LITE Immunization – Details screen must be updated to reflect *LINKS* as the Verification Source. ****

***** For school-aged children, if the client states verbally that the child has had all required immunizations and the child is currently enrolled in school and this information has been documented in the Case Notes, * update the LITE Immunization – Details screen to reflect *School* as the Verification Source.**

The LITE Immunization – Details screen must be updated to reflect exemptions based on medical reasons and religious grounds. Case notes must be documented thoroughly. **

	Agency Name	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	B – Eligibility Factors
	Section No./Name	B-700 Immunization
	Document No./Name	B-710-FITAP Immunization
	Effective Date	May 1, 2023

Document all activities justifying case closure or rejection due to failure to comply. This documentation should include all offers of assistance made to the client and the client's response or lack of response to the offers of assistance.

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

[CR 9 Form/Instructions](#) Immunizations Record

[OFS IM Form/Instructions](#) Request for Verification of Immunizations

IV. REFERENCES

[Louisiana Administrative Code – Title 67 Social Services, Subpart 2- Chapter 12: Family Independence Temporary Assistance Program, Subchapter B – Conditions of Eligibility](#)

[Louisiana Administrative Code – Title 67 Social Services, Subpart 12- Chapter 51: Child Care Assistance Program, Subchapter A – Administration, Conditions of Eligibility, and Funding](#)